# Indian state AI policy activity: research findings

Research cutoff: 10 November 2026. Collection window: 1 January 2024 to the cutoff. This report interprets the accompanying event and source records; it is not a census of Indian AI activity or a ranking of state performance.

The clearest distinction in this sample is between **permission to act, capacity to deliver, documented use, and demonstrated benefit**. A cabinet approval establishes a decision. A procurement notice establishes that a department is seeking a solution. A service launch establishes availability at a particular time. None, by itself, establishes accuracy, fairness, sustained adoption or public benefit.

Several states have moved beyond broad declarations into identifiable administrative steps: Gujarat has issued challenge funding and acceptance rules; Rajasthan has published AI infrastructure procurement documents; Odisha has notified implementation rules; and Telangana has documented a wider rollout of a specific approval service. These are useful evidence of progress because the responsible body, action and supporting document can be identified. They still require follow-up on execution and outcomes. Gujarat challenge rules, Rajasthan GPU tender, Odisha operational rules, BuildNow rollout report.

## Why these twelve states

The selection deliberately combines southern states with substantial technology and public-service activity (Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana); western industrial and institutional settings (Gujarat and Maharashtra); populous northern and central administrations (Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh); and eastern and northeastern cases (Odisha and Assam). This supplies geographical variation and different administrative routes: budgets, government orders, partnerships, public procurement, education programmes and sector-specific services.

This is a purposeful research design, not a representative statistical sample. Accessible official documents and the ability to verify an action influenced retention. English-language discovery and readable web documents also influence what appears. The sample therefore supports comparisons of **documented approaches and evidence quality**, not estimates of national prevalence, state spending, adoption rates or relative success. Missing records mean that this collection has not established an action, not that the action did not occur.

## State comparison

"Delivery gap" below means evidence still missing from this collection, not proof of a programme failure. Record IDs allow the reader to inspect the exact date basis, stage and limitations in the dataset.

| State | Distinguishing documented action | Evidence supporting the comparison | Delivery gap to investigate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Andhra Pradesh | Approved operating guidelines for a data-centre policy with an explicit AI infrastructure objective. | `AP-2025-04`: G.O.Ms.No.12, 2 May 2025. | Incentive eligibility and approved guidelines do not establish commissioned AI capacity or benefits from public-service applications. |
| Assam | Reported an operating government GPU cluster, alongside earlier budget proposals for AI institutions. | `as-2026-gpu`: July 2026 reporting quoting named officials. | Exact commissioning day, utilization and application performance are not verified. Eight nodes is not an established GPU count. |
| Gujarat | Put an AI action plan into an administrative structure and issued funding and acceptance rules for challenge projects. | `gj-implementation-cell-2026`, `gj-challenge-modalities-2026`: cell circular and challenge circular. | Need selected use cases, accepted results, production decisions and actual payments. Rules alone do not show execution. |
| Karnataka | Proposed a five-year investment in the Centre for Applied AI for Tech Solutions, alongside sector-specific budget uses. | `KA-2025-01`: 2025-26 budget, paragraph 357. | Later reported funding amounts and the relationship to the earlier AI centre need reconciliation before any financial comparison. |

| State | Distinguishing documented action | Evidence supporting the comparison | Delivery gap to investigate |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kerala | Used the public education system for teacher training and curriculum changes; an annual report provides period-specific training output. | `KL-2024-01`, `KL-2024-02`: KITE annual report. | Training counts do not establish classroom use or learning gains. Targets and fiscal-year completions have different meanings. |
| Madhya Pradesh | Signed separately identifiable agreements for AI labs, multilingual services and a proposed AI centre. | `mp-indiaai-labs-mou-2026`, `mp-bhashini-mou-2026`, `mp-nasscom-coe-mou-2026`: PIB conference account, BHASHINI agreement, MPSeDC account. | Need lab openings, service integrations and centre staffing. Signing does not establish any of those outcomes. |
| Maharashtra | Adopted a sector-specific agricultural AI policy before its wider AI policy; later reporting records an approved government AI software package. | `mh-agri-policy-2025`: agricultural policy; `mh-sarvam-approval-2026`: approval reporting. | Proposed agricultural allocation and software package outlay are different financial objects; neither supplies expenditure or adoption evidence. |
| Odisha | Published a policy in the Gazette and subsequently notified rules for implementation and procurement. | `od-2025-policy-gazette`, `od-2026-operational-rules`: policy Gazette, rules Gazette. | Need records showing project selection, oversight bodies operating and safeguards applied to actual systems. |
| Rajasthan | Has a traceable draft-to-approval-to-launch sequence and concrete AI infrastructure procurement preparation. | `rj-ai-policy-approval-2025`: CMO cabinet release; `rj-gpu-tender-2026`: GPU RFP. | Need award, delivery, commissioning and acceptance records. A tender is a request to the market, not installed capacity. |
| Tamil Nadu | Has both a documented sectoral launch and a formal AI mission order with administrative sanction. | `TN-2024-01`: Madukkarai field reporting; `TN-2024-04`: mission G.O.25. | A physical installation and an administrative sanction answer different questions; neither establishes a causal improvement in outcomes. |
| Telangana | Documented extending an AI-assisted building approval service and launching a state data and AI platform. | `tg-2025-buildnow`, `tg-2025-tgdex`: BuildNow expansion, TGDeX launch. | Need independent service-time and error measures, plus a dated platform inventory to reconcile conflicting dataset counts. |
| Uttar Pradesh | Has distinct mission announcement, annual budget and cabinet approval milestones. | `up-2026-mission-announcement`: PIB; `up-2026-budget`: budget highlights; `up-2026-mission-approval`: cabinet reporting. | Need the underlying cabinet order, expenditure releases and delivery evidence. The mission-scale announcement is not an annual budget total. |

## Six findings

### 1. State AI activity follows several administrative routes

The evidence does not support a single sequence in which a comprehensive policy must precede every application. Tamil Nadu's elephant-detection system was launched in February 2024, before the October order approving its AI mission. Gujarat inaugurated the GIFT City AI Centre of Excellence on 27 January 2025, before its action-plan resolution of 24 July 2025. These are different institutional paths, not evidence that a state with an earlier policy is necessarily more effective. Records: `TN-2024-01`, `TN-2024-04`, `gj-coe-inauguration-2025`, `gj-action-plan-2025`. Tamil Nadu deployment, mission order, Gujarat inauguration, official resolution references.

The implication for the dashboard is to show the action and its stage together. “Policy approved,” “agreement signed” and “service operational” should not be converted into a single progress score. An operational service may cover one location; a signed agreement may describe an entire state.

## 2. Specific applications offer better delivery evidence than broad targets

BuildNow's expansion to the Hyderabad Metropolitan Development Authority region is a defined service and geographical rollout. Madukkarai's detection system has a visible physical installation and an identified alert workflow. Assam's GPU report identifies infrastructure said to be serving applications. Each is more specific about what exists than a proposed city, mission or training target. Records: `tg-2025-buildnow`, `TN-2024-01`, `as-2026-gpu`. State service, field reporting, Assam reporting.

The remaining evaluation questions differ by application. Building approvals require end-to-end processing times, error and appeal rates, and clarity about human decisions. Elephant detection requires false alerts, missed detections and an appropriate comparison for collision outcomes. Government AI computing requires uptime, use and application-level performance. These are proposed evaluation measures; the collection does not claim to possess them.

## 3. Procurement and acceptance documents make implementation assessable

Gujarat's February 2026 challenge circular specifies project selection, success criteria, departmental acceptance and staged payment. Rajasthan's GPU RFP identifies a buyer, hardware scope and estimated procurement value. Assam's procurement-platform request seeks market input and is explicitly an earlier step. Records: `gj-challenge-modalities-2026`, `rj-gpu-tender-2026`, `as-2026-appi`. Gujarat circular, Rajasthan RFP, Assam request for information.

These documents suggest a practical follow-up sequence: identify the resulting award; link the supplier and contract to the original notice; obtain delivery and acceptance records; then check ongoing service reports. A later press release should not silently replace an earlier project identifier or erase a cancellation. Tender values and indicative funding ceilings should remain separate from contractual obligations and payments.

## 4. Skills announcements require a denominator and a reporting period

Kerala's KITE annual report records 31,878 teachers trained in FY2024-25; contemporary launch reporting described an 80,000-teacher target. These figures can coexist because one describes reported delivery in a period and the other planned reach. Uttar Pradesh's AI Pragya one-million-young-people figure is a target in its launch report. Comparing those numbers as achieved training would be invalid. Records: `KL-2024-01`, `up-2025-pragya`. KITE annual report, teacher-training launch reporting, AI Pragya announcement.

A useful future comparison would distinguish registered participants, attendees, completions, assessment passes and subsequent use. It would also separate teachers, students and officials and avoid adding overlapping groups. The present evidence supports different programme designs and reported outputs, not a ranking of workforce readiness.

## 5. Responsible AI provisions differ in administrative specificity

Rajasthan's cabinet release describes privacy, fairness, explainability and departmental AI officers. Odisha has issued operational rules. Tamil Nadu's policy note describes departmental concurrence and assessment arrangements, while Karnataka's record establishes a responsible-AI committee's first meeting. These are identifiable governance actions with different scopes. Records: `rj-ai-policy-approval-2025`, `od-2026-operational-rules`, `TN-2026-01`, `KA-2026-01`. Rajasthan release, Odisha rules, Tamil Nadu policy note, Karnataka meeting report.

Rajasthan also signed a distinct legal and ethical AI collaboration with NLU Jodhpur, whose own announcement confirms execution on 6 January 2026 and the planned advice, training and research. Record: `rj-nlu-mou-2026`. University announcement.

None of those records establishes that a particular deployed system passed an assessment, that an affected person obtained a remedy, or that an audit found and corrected a problem. A useful next evidence layer would attach published assessments, approval conditions, audit findings and grievance procedures to named applications. This would distinguish a written safeguard from its use.

## 6. Repeated partners create comparable questions, not comparable outcomes

Google agreements appear in multiple states, including Tamil Nadu, Telangana, Uttar Pradesh and Andhra Pradesh. Their scopes differ: ecosystem and workforce support, cross-sector applications, an agricultural service network, and government-service pilots. “Signed with Google” is therefore too coarse a description for comparison. Records: `TN-2024-03`, `tg-2025-google`, `up-2025-google`, `AP-2024-01`. Tamil Nadu release, Telangana reporting, Uttar Pradesh reporting, Andhra Pradesh reporting.

Research should track the actual deliverable, department, timetable and public documentation for each agreement. Partner announcements establish commitments but do not independently validate effectiveness. The event unit is the distinct action, counterparty and milestone. Rajasthan's Google, IIT Delhi and NLU agreements are separate records because follow-up evidence identifies different commitments; clauses within a single agreement stay together. PIB's collective Wadhwani mention was not expanded into a fourth agreement without clearer evidence. Records: `rj-google-mou-2026`, `rj-iit-delhi-mou-2026`, `rj-nlu-mou-2026`. Partner-specific reporting, PIB account.

A newspaper reprinted on a government or partner website is still the same underlying report. The dataset preserves that distinction instead of treating every additional URL as independent corroboration.

## Five cases that materially change interpretation

**1. Odisha has several valid dates for one policy.** The Gazette records cabinet approval on 28 May 2025, an underlying resolution dated 18 June, and publication on 28 October. The policy text links its operating period to Gazette notification. The retained approval and publication records are separate milestones in the same initiative. Assigning the news date to every step would erase the distinction. Records: `od-2025-policy-approval`, `od-2025-policy-gazette`. Official Gazette.

**2. An official index can disagree with its own document.** Maharashtra's policy index lists 16 May 2026, while the linked Government Resolution header reads 6 May 2026. The resolution record uses the document date and discloses the conflict. Cabinet approval on 29 April is a separate event, supported by a 30 April bulletin saying “yesterday.” Records: `mh-ai-policy-gr-2026`, `mh-ai-policy-cabinet-2026`. Official index, resolution PDF, cabinet bulletin.

**3. A launch headline and a second ceremony can inflate delivery counts.** The Uttar Pradesh agriculture-network headline uses “launch,” but the body establishes an MoU, so the event remains signed. Separately, a parliamentary answer dates the UPDESCO labs agreement to 26 September 2025; PIB describes a January 2026 ceremony without establishing whether the instrument was renewed or expanded. It is not counted as a second agreement. Records: `up-2025-google`, `up-2025-datalabs`. Agriculture report, parliamentary answer, PIB ceremony account.

**4. Similar currency figures represent different things.** Uttar Pradesh's roughly Rs 2,000 crore mission announcement cannot be added to the FY2026-27 Rs 225 crore mission provision as independent spending. Karnataka's Rs 5 crore prison-equipment package and Tamil Nadu's Rs 50 crore emerging-technology college package are not AI-only allocations. Assam's adjacent Rs 5 crore Gyan Dhara allocation is for virtual reality, not its proposed AI centre. Records: `up-2026-budget`, `KA-2024-02`, `TN-2025-01`, `as-2024-coe`. UP budget, Karnataka reporting, Tamil Nadu budget, Assam budget.

**5. Agreement on a project does not imply agreement on its schedule.** Invest UP and AM Group both describe the proposed 1 GW Greater Noida AI-compute hub, but the government release points to full capacity by 2028 while the company's release gives first capacity in 2028 and full capacity by 2030. The signed agreement is retained; neither deadline is promoted to a verified completion forecast. The proposed private investment is not state expenditure. Record: `up-2026-amgreen`. Invest UP release, AM Group release.

## What the next research pass should resolve

The highest-value follow-up is evidence of execution, rather than additional articles repeating announcements. For the named procurement cases, obtain awards and acceptance records. For training, obtain dated completion and assessment data with consistent populations. For public services, seek usage, errors, appeals and outcome evaluations. For responsible AI, identify assessments and oversight decisions tied to actual systems. For infrastructure partnerships, reconcile project scope and phases before adding capacity or investment figures.

The dashboard's activity totals should remain counts of retained events in a verified sample. They are not counts of distinct policies, operating services, successful interventions or independent sources. The source ledger and record-level limitations are essential parts of the result, particularly where formal orders were not retrieved, dates remain unknown, or source claims have not been independently tested.